Blommer CHOCOLATE COMPANY

Campbellford, ON • East Greenville, PA • Chicago, IL • Union City, CA

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BLOMMER CHOCOLATE COMPANY
HACCP/ Preventive Controls
Summary

Blommer Chocolate Company facilities, located in East Greenville PA, Chicago, IL, Union City, CA and Campbellford, ON are compliant to the US Food and Drug Administration's (FDA) Food Safety Modernization Act (FSMA), to CFIA's Safe Food for Canadians regulation, and to the Global Codex Alimentarius General Principles of Food Hygiene including the pre-work and 7 principles of HACCP. Our Food Safety Plans, which contain CCP summary tables for each site's type of product manufacturing, are highly confidential and include proprietary information. These documents are only available for review on-site. This summary outlines the critical controls (CCP) and preventive controls (PC) in place to follow regulations and diligently address potential food safety risks.

All inputs to each process (materials, ingredients, equipment, environment) as well as each step in the manufacturing process are analyzed for potential microbiological, physical, and chemical food safety hazards, including allergens, radiation, regulated substances such as heavy metals, unapproved additives and pesticides. The results of this analysis determine the use and nature of necessary controls, both preventive and at specific points in manufacturing.
All raw cocoa beans are roasted in a thermal process which is validated to provide a 6-log reduction of Salmonella (the organism of eminent risk) at minimum. The roaster validations are certified with an outside process authority, and any time there is a significant change to the system, a re-validation is conducted. Monitoring the achievement of critical parameters required per the validation study is a Process Preventive Control (a Critical Control Point in HACCP), and all Blommer plants maintain monitoring records as well as verification activities to ensure this control is effective. Blommer uses a robust environmental monitoring program to provide further verification that effective controls for Salmonella are in place.

Our ingredients are purchased only from approved suppliers as part of our Supply Chain Program. This includes the requirements of the FDA's Foreign Supplier Verification Program when imported materials are used in Blommer's manufacturing facilities. Our supplier evaluation process requires suppliers to submit a hazard analysis that identifies all known or reasonably foreseeable food safety hazards and corresponding controls in place to significant minimize or prevent the hazard or help ensure the food has not been adulterated, misbranded, or is unsafe. This includes mycotoxins, heavy metals, pesticides, and Salmonella (which Blommer has already addressed with critical controls). Suppliers must affirm their responsibility for controlling those hazards.

Where materials are considered high risk due to the potential for certain pathogens, verification of acceptable microbiological testing results (via material COA) must be completed prior to use in Blommer products. Other verification activities in that Supply Chain Preventive Control include supplier audits, specification agreements, evaluation of suppliers' food safety system and inbound inspection. Blommer finished product verification testing including Aerobic Plate Count, Coliform, E. coli, Yeast, Mold and Salmonella spp., via a ISO 17025 certified third-party laboratory.

Blommer manufactures some products that contain milk and / or soy. Our Allergen Control Program requires containment measures to limit cross contact, including segregated storage of allergen-containing ingredients and finished product labeling. When our sites are manufacturing with allergen-containing materials, equipment changeover procedures, visual inspections, and dry-cleaning procedures (including flush) are in place to mitigate potential cross-contamination by allergens. Allergens are coded and colored stickers are used to identify allergens. Utensils are also color coded with the specific color that denotes their use. To ensure that Blommer fully identifies and communicates allergen critical information, the label of every input and every finished product is monitored through a Food Allergen Preventive Control.

Blommer has many other policies and standards (GMPs, prerequisite programs) that reduce or eliminate potential microbiological, chemical, and physical food safety hazards, specifically foreign material. As close to the end of the manufacturing process as possible, we use the lowest detection limits within our capability to identify and remove substances in the size range of food safety concern. Depending on the nature of the product and the potential physical hazard, the Process Preventive Control (CCP) may be metal detection. These devices are monitored before and after every lot of packaged product, at minimum, and any findings are investigated.

Every Blommer site has employees in multiple functions and leadership levels who have completed Preventive Controls Qualified Individual (PCQI) training and oversee the activities of Qualified Individuals (QI) who are monitoring CCPs and PCs, performing verification activities, and completing records review. Each Blommer site has a Food Safety Team that is responsible for reviewing the Food Safety Plan annually at minimum and when changes that could affect the safety of the product occur.

Blommer does not release product for shipping until monitoring is complete, microbiological testing is within specification, and corrective action records are reviewed. These records, along with the site Food Safety Plans, including CCP summary tables, detailed manufacturing process flows, and the hazard analysis for each type of product manufacturing, are highly confidential and include proprietary information. These documents are only available for review on-site and we are not able to share via email.

If you wish to discuss further or have questions, please contact chocdocs@blommer.com